

OBJECTIVE CONDITIONS

Researcher's Race, Class, Gender, Age, Ethnicity, and Nationality

Is the purpose of the research to systematically observe a group of individuals within their own setting for the purpose of understanding human social behavior?

NO

Select another research design

Critique researcher's own race, class, gender, ethnic, & generation biases as they will shape each step in the research process: selection of research problem, critical summary & analysis of previous research, assumptions of unit(s) of analysis, development/use of theory, methods of selecting, collecting, recording, organizing, & analyzing data, selection & treatment of 'research subjects'/participants, conclusions drawn, & outcomes of research efforts

Identify the research problem/interest

Literature Review → preliminary review to clearly define research problem → Research Problem

Describe the context of research problem/issue

Construct a plan of action: consider the issue, target population members & needs, data collection design, data analysis design, information & resource needs, available human & material resources, and timeframe

Conduct a comprehensive literature review, inclusive of how others have studied a similar issue(s) &/or population members

Arrange historically, chronologically, & logically; Reveal & critically summarize the race, class, gender, ethnic, & generational biases at all stages of research reviewed—problem selection, theoretical framework, research design, conclusions & recommendations, aim of research (observed in how findings were used)

Identify population to study & carefully select site

Theoretical Frame → Establish conceptual model of the relationships between central elements/variables that will be observed → Research Question

Generate clear & precise conceptual definitions of concepts & variables to be studied & define how they will be observed &/or measured in the target population

Select data collection design(s)

Interview: group &/or individual

Observation: participant, participant as observer, observer, observer as participant

Identify data collection techniques

Observation

Note-Taking

Media recording: video, audio, electronic

Construct appropriate data collection instruments

Questionnaires &/or list of questions—open-ended useful in field research

Checklist, field journal, diagrams, maps, etc.

Acquire/Construct appropriate data recording instruments: video, camera, film, computer, cassette recorder, etc.

Train research team, if necessary, according to appropriate data collection design—thoroughness & precision are key

Develop guiding principles on ethical behavior suitable to particular research problem/issue, population, & observation site & STICK TO THEM

Gain permission & access to site/ population under study

Gather data: carefully employing all senses

POINT OF DATA REDUCTION: Researchers collect data according to what they consider 'worthy' of research; worthiness is shaped by the historical conditions that produced them, including their race, class, gender, & ethnicity. Therefore it is important to record even that which the researcher deems unimportant.

Refine concepts & revise relationship models, assumptions, 'hypothesis,' & research approach as data are gathered

Organize, and process data (enter into computer, clean of error & bias, etc.)—assign meaning to the data collected

Analyze & synthesize data

Interpret data & summarize findings

Determine meaning & implications of findings in relation to research concern/ issue

Propose practical recommendations for addressing concern/issue & for future research

Report & present findings in document, publication, presentation, etc.

Assess implications of study, as well as lessons learned practically, theoretically, ethically, & methodologically: what worked, what didn't, & under what circumstances

Develop policy/standards/guiding principles according to lessons learned